PATIENT HANDOUT · AMMP-8 SALIVA / MOUTH-RINSE SCREEN

What is this mouth test, and why does it matter for you?

We use a quick screening test to check whether your gums are actively breaking down right now — and whether that inflammation may connect to your overall health.

Plain-language idea: this test looks for a "breakdown signal" made by your immune system when gum tissue is under attack.

1

Your body reacts

When bacteria bother your gums, your immune system sends help. That response is normal.

2

Sometimes it overdoes it

If the reaction stays too active, it can start breaking down the tissues that hold your teeth.

3

We measure the signal

The test checks for **aMMP-8**, a protein linked to active tissue breakdown — in real time.

Bacteria bother gums	Immune "helpers" arrive	aMMP-8 rises	We test saliva
Starts the immune response	Inflammation begins	Active breakdown signal	See your level today

What aMMP-8 means

aMMP-8 is a natural enzyme your body can make when inflammation is actively damaging tissue.

- It is not a test for one germ.
- It is not the same as "do I have cavities?"
- It helps show if gum damage is happening *now*.
- It helps us track whether treatment is working.

What your result may mean

LOWER	Usually a calmer response. We still protect your gums with good care and checkups.
RAISED	More active inflammation. We may recommend deeper cleaning, closer follow-up, and home-care changes.
VERY HIGH	Strong active breakdown signal. We treat gum health and may discuss whole-body inflammation risk with your doctor.

Mouth health and body health are connected

Mouth	↔	Body
Active gum inflammation and tissue stress		Same immune system and shared inflammation pathways

Your mouth and body share the same immune system. Long-lasting gum inflammation can add to overall inflammatory stress. That is why very high results may lead us to coordinate with your primary care provider.

In people with diabetes or prediabetes and periodontitis, mouth-rinse aMMP-8 fell after nonsurgical gum treatment (more on average in prediabetes), supporting point-of-care aMMP-8 as a real-time monitoring aid alongside medical diabetes care, not a stand-alone diagnosis.

What this means for you

This screening helps us see if your gums are quietly under attack before more damage builds up. If your number is high, we don't panic — we make a plan: treat the gums, re-check the signal, and if needed, connect care with your medical doctor for whole-body health. Please ask our team to explain your personal result.

Source: Umeizudike KA et al., 2026. *Periodontal Therapy-Related Changes in Clinical Parameters, Active-Matrix Metalloproteinase-8 and C-Reactive Protein in Prediabetes and Diabetes. Oral Diseases.* DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/odi.70481. PMID: 42745208.